Thu N.M. Nguyen

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Academic Appointments

Lecturer in Finance 08.2025–present
Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

Academic Visits

Visiting Researcher 2026
House of Finance, Goethe University Frankfurt

Visiting Researcher 2026
Institute for Finance, Banking and Insurance, WU Vienna University of Economics and Business

Education

PhD in Finance 2021–2025
Amsterdam Business School, University of Amsterdam
Thesis title: "Market Concentration, Institutional Demand, and Risk Factors in Asset Pricing"
Supervisors: Aleksandar Andonov and Esther Eiling

MPhil Economics 2019–2021
Tinbergen Institute
Specialization: Econometrics and Finance

BSc Econometrics & Operations Research 2016–2019
Maastricht University

Education Abroad Program 2018
University of California, Los Angeles

International Baccalaureate Diploma 2014–2016
Auckland International College

Working Papers

1. Market Concentration, Capital Misallocation, and Asset Pricing [Link]

Pacific-Basin Finance Journal Research Excellence Award 2025
John A. Doukas PhD Best Paper Award at EFMA Annual Meeting 2025
Best PhD Paper Award at the 7th Asset Pricing Conference by LTI@UniTo

Last update: 25th September 2026

Superstar firms, which dominate stock markets through their large size and high markups, can distort efficient capital allocation. This paper empirically studies the asset pricing implications of superstar firms through the channel of capital misallocation, measured by the cross-sectional dispersion in the marginal product of capital (MPK). I decompose this measure into misallocation (1) among superstar firms, (2) among other firms, and (3) between these two groups. I find that only changes in the third component, termed the "MPK spread", are negatively priced in the cross-section of stock returns. Stocks with negative exposure to these changes outperform stocks with positive exposure by 4.8% per year. In the long run, a higher MPK spread predicts lower economic growth and aggregate stock returns, while in the short run, it predicts lower innovation growth. Consistent with the ICAPM framework, capital misallocation between superstar and non-superstar firms is a key state variable, and its changes capture a macroeconomic risk factor.

Conferences and seminars: Rotterdam School of Management Brownbag Seminar, Rotterdam 2026; MRS International Risk Conference, Boston 2025; Robeco Research Seminar, Rotterdam 2025; EFMA Annual Meeting, Athens 2025; EAYE Annual Meeting, London 2025; AFA/ASSA PhD Student Poster Session, San Francisco 2025; Nederlandse Economendag, Den Haag 2024; 7th Asset Pricing Conference by LTI@UniTo, Turin 2024; C.R.E.D.I.T. Poster Session, Venice 2024; ICMA Doctoral Finance Symposium, Reading 2024; University of Amsterdam Finance Brownbag Seminar, Amsterdam 2024; Tinbergen Institute PhD Seminar, Amsterdam 2024; University of Amsterdam PhD Seminar, Amsterdam 2024.

2. Intermediary Asset Pricing Through the Lens of a Demand System, with D. Lee [Link]

How does broker-dealers' leverage shift asset prices when their assets under management are relatively small? We explore the channel through which broker-dealers extend leverage to hedge funds using an asset demand system. During recessions, broker-dealers face binding leverage constraints and reduce their borrowing to hedge funds. Then, hedge funds are forced to sell assets and deleverage, creating demand pressures that shift asset prices. We find that hedge funds exert the largest price impact across all stocks among institutions, and their price impact increases substantially during crises as they need to deleverage. On average, a 1% increase in broker-dealers' leverage raises the price impact of the average hedge fund by 2% in the following year. These impacts are more pronounced among illiquid stocks. Our findings suggest that hedge funds significantly influence stock prices when broker-dealers' leverage constraints are binding.

Conferences and seminars: University of Amsterdam Finance Brownbag Seminar, Amsterdam 2023; University of Amsterdam PhD Seminar, Amsterdam 2023.

3. Overlapping Factors [Link]

Characteristic-based factors, such as value, momentum, and low volatility, are constructed from the same universe of stocks. Therefore, they can contain some of the same stocks. Although the degree of overlap among these factors is not excessive, I find that the overlap matters. Stocks included simultaneously in the same leg across multiple factors, so-called overlapping stocks, earn an average abnormal return of 66 basis points per month. In contrast, pure factor stocks included in a single factor earn on average, across all factors, only 5 basis points per month, despite similar characteristics, industry composition, institutional ownership, and portfolio turnover. Further, the portfolio of overlapping stocks is priced in the cross-section of stock returns, while the portfolio of all pure factor stocks is not. Exposures to macroeconomic and liquidity risks cannot explain the return difference. Only in the short leg, overlapping stocks are more exposed to investor sentiment and have a higher short interest than pure factor stocks.

Conferences and seminars: Frontiers of Factor Investing Conference, Lancaster 2022; University of Amsterdam Finance Brownbag Seminar, Amsterdam 2022; University of Amsterdam PhD Seminar, Amsterdam 2022.

Teaching Experience

Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

- **Lecturer**
  - Investerings Analyse & Portfoliomanagement (BSc) 2026–present
  - Blockchain and Decentralized Finance (MSc) 2026–present
  - Methods Master Classes (BSc) 2026–present
  - Alternative Investments (BSc) 2025–present
- **Master Thesis Coordinator**, MSc Finance & Investments 2025–present
- **Bachelor Project Supervisor**, BSc International Business Administration 2026
- **Course Assistant**, Applied Investments (MSc) 2025

Amsterdam Business School, University of Amsterdam

- **Teaching Assistant (Tutorials)**
  - Financial Economics and Quantitative Methods (MSc) 2021–2025
  - Finance 1 (BSc) 2023–2025
  - Investment and Portfolio Theory II (BSc) 2025
- **Bachelor Thesis Supervisor**, BSc EBE and BSc BA 2022–2024

Tinbergen Institute

- **Teaching Assistant (Tutorials)**
  - Asset Pricing (PhD course) 2021
  - Principles of Programming in Econometrics (PhD course) 2020

Awards, Grants, and Scholarships

Women in Intermediary Asset Pricing Research Grant 2026

University Teaching Qualification (Basis Kwalificatie Onderwijs) 2026

CFA Program Professor Scholarship 2025

Pacific-Basin Finance Journal Research Excellence Award 2025

John A. Doukas PhD Best Paper Award, EFMA Annual Meeting 2025

Travel Grant, AFA/ASSA Annual Meeting 2025

Best PhD Paper Award, 7th Asset Pricing Conference by LTI@UniTo 2024

Travel Grant, EFA Annual Meeting 2024

Amsterdam University Fund for the PhD Program, University of Amsterdam 2021–2025

Scholarship for the MPhil Program, Tinbergen Institute 2019–2021

Thesis Prize in Econometrics, Maastricht University 2020

Cum Laude and Honors Degree, Maastricht University 2019

Dean's List and Effort Award, Auckland International College 2016

Gifted Student Scholarship, Auckland International College 2014–2016

Discussions

"Who Moves the Long End? The Dynamics of Bond Market Segmentation" by S. Ding and R. Czech
13th SAFE Asset Pricing Workshop 2026

"ETFs as Strategic Tools in Institutional Portfolios"
Financial Investigator Lunch Webinar Discussion 2026

"Investment Lumpiness and Equity Returns" by Z. Ren, L. Wang, and Y. Wu
MRS International Risk Conference 2025

"Not All Disasters are Alike: Extreme Weather Events and Stock Performance" by S. Hamid and Q. Kang
EFMA Annual Meeting 2025

"Blades of Carry: The Big Short" by A. Hedieh Shahini
ICMA Doctoral Finance Symposium 2024

Academic Service

Conference Reviewer
European Association of Young Economists (EAYE) Annual Meeting 2026

PhD Council Member
Faculty of Economics and Business, University of Amsterdam 2023–2025

Conference Organization Assistant
International Centre for Pension Management (ICPM) Discussion Forum, Utrecht 2024
EFA 50th Annual Meeting, Amsterdam 2023

Miscellaneous

Software: R, Python, Stata, SQL, LaTeX, MS Office

Languages: Vietnamese (native), English (fluent), Dutch (B1)

Nationality: Dutch

Gender: Female; Pronouns: She/her